COUNTY OF MARIN

26

Voter Information Guide and Sample Ballot

Tuesday, November 3, 2026

General Election

DON'T BE LATE

Return your ballot before Election Day, and please use a ballot drop box.

All active registered voters will be mailed a vote by mail ballot, starting October 5

Return it by mail, into an Official Drop Box, or to a Vote Center

You may vote in person at any one of 21 Marin Vote Centers, see next pages for times and locations

All Vote Centers and Drop Boxes close at 8:00 pm on November 3

Marin County Elections Department
3501 Civic Center Drive, Room 121
San Rafael, CA 94903
415-473-6456 | elections@marincounty.gov
www.marinvotes.org

MARIN VOTES!

COUNTY OF MARIN

MEASURES SUBMITTED TO THE VOTERS

COUNTY

CHILD CARE INITIATIVE

MEASURE P

Shall the Marin County Child Care Initiative be adopted to levy a special parcel tax of 5 cents per building square foot, generating approximately $12.5 million annually for fifteen years, to fund affordable childcare and high-quality early childhood education and improve compensation to retain and attract educators, with public disclosure, optional annual inflation adjustments, and a corresponding increase in the County appropriations limit, with all funds used locally in Marin County?

◯ YES ◯ NO

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS BY COUNTY COUNSEL

COUNTY OF MARIN
MEASURE P

This Measure was placed on the ballot following submission of a voter initiative petition containing the number of signatures required by law.

Because Measure P was placed on the ballot through the initiative process, it will be adopted if approved by a majority of the votes cast in this election. If it is adopted, the County of Marin will levy a parcel tax beginning the first full fiscal year after the effective date. The Measure will remain in effect for fifteen years from the beginning of the parcel tax. The initial rate of the parcel tax shall be $0.05 per square foot of structural improvements, with no more than 100,000 square feet per parcel subject to the tax. "Structural improvements" is defined as the square footage of building floor area on a parcel. Beginning with the second fiscal year in which the tax is in effect, the Board of Supervisors may annually adjust the tax in accordance with the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers for the San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward area. The County of Marin estimates revenue from this Measure will average approximately $12,500,000 annually.

The revenue raised by this parcel tax must be placed in a special account and can only be used for the purposes stated in this Measure. The stated purposes for the funds raised by this special tax include increasing access to child care, preschool and early education services to benefit low- and middle-income children and families of Marin County; improving wages for child-care providers who provide those services; developing, maintaining, upgrading, and expanding early-care and education facilities; and administrative expenses up to 5% of annual Fund proceeds. The Measure restricts the use of tax proceeds to replace certain existing funding for child care and early education.

Responsibility for developing, administering, and overseeing the programs and services paid for by the parcel tax revenue will belong to the Marin County Children and Families Commission ("Commission"), a nine-member commission whose members the Board of Supervisors appoints. The Commission will develop a five-year program plan and budget, and allocate the funds from the parcel tax, which the Board of Supervisors must appropriate annually.

Measure P additionally creates an eleven-member Advisory Council to develop recommendations for the Commission regarding the five-year plan, annual expenditures, and implementation of the Measure. The Board of Supervisors will appoint the Advisory Council members. Measure P requires the Marin County Board of Supervisors to provide for an annual independent financial audit of the parcel tax fund, which the Advisory Council must review.

The Commission will evaluate the effectiveness of the five-year plan and provide staff support for the Advisory Council, and may contract with other entities and consult with outside experts in administering the Measure.

s/BRANDON W. HALTER
County Counsel

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE P

A child's earliest years are among the most important for brain development. The experiences children have during this critical period help shape how they learn, grow, communicate, and can determine whether they succeed in school and throughout life.

But in Marin, too many families cannot find or afford quality early childhood education. 52% of Marin children ages 0–12 with working parents lack access to licensed preschool. Long waiting lists and high costs force parents to reduce their work hours, turn down opportunities, or leave the workforce altogether.

Voting YES on Measure P is an investment in our children — and in Marin's economic future.

Measure P will make high-quality early childhood education more affordable, create more child care spaces, and help attract and retain qualified child care educators. That means more children will have access to safe, high-quality early learning experiences that are essential for healthy development and kindergarten readiness.

It also means more parents can work.

Reliable child care helps local businesses recruit and retain employees, strengthens household economic security, and supports a workforce that keeps Marin's businesses, schools, health care system, and senior communities running. Investing in children early pays dividends across our community for years to come.

Every dollar stays in Marin County, with annual independent audits, public reporting, regular evaluations, and strict limits on administrative costs.

That is why Measure P is supported by early childhood educators, elementary school teachers, the League of Women Voters, Congressman Jared Huffman, Senator Mike McGuire, Assemblymember Damon Connolly, all five Marin County Supervisors, the Marin County Democratic Party, and the North Bay Leadership Council.

For healthier children, thriving families, and a stronger local economy, vote YES on Measure P.

Learn more at OurKidsMarin.org

NELSON BRONCO, MD
FAAP Pediatrician

PATTY GARBARINO
Business Leader

MATT WILLIS
Public Health Physician

MARY JANE BURKE
Marin County Superintendent Emerita

LEAGUE OF WOMEN VOTERS OF MARIN COUNTY
Becky Bingea, President

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE P

Measure P "It's Not Ready for Prime Time"

— Dick Spotswood, Marin IJ Opinion columnist, 8/23/26

Despite its "mom and apple pie" promises, Measure P fails to help Marin residents.

In fact, it isn't designed to solve the childcare affordability crisis in Marin. The only stated goal of Measure P that's measurable is to give carers income "parity" with TK-12 public school teachers. This will increase childcare costs at licensed preschools while driving more parents to leave their kids with unlicensed providers. A few families at undefined middle to low-income levels may benefit from subsidies but there are no guarantees.

Measure P is carefully written to avoid a Marin residency requirement. That means people outside of Marin will benefit from the tax yet Marin property owners will pay for it. Voters shouldn't be tricked into believing that the money will only benefit Marin families.

This new childcare tax is a mandatory cost imposed on hard working Marin families already struggling with their own high childcare costs. The extra burden is even more objectionable because these families will subsidize out-of-county families.

Supporters say reliable childcare helps local businesses "recruit and retain employees." But if childcare is a necessary employee benefit, employers should foot the bill or compensate their employees enough to cover it.

With over half of its reported $778,305 campaign donations coming from outsiders - Washington D.C, Sonoma, Berkeley, and Los Altos - Measure P is using Marin to test voter support for another blank check tax dressed up as a targeted solution.

REJECT Measure P.

TIEF GIBBS
Marin County resident and business owner

LUCY DILWORTH
Coalition of Sensible Taxpayers Director and former Marin County Civil Grand Jury foreperson

MARGARITA COLIN
Marin County Resident

MARK GALPERIN
Marin County Resident

AMANDA BEYER
Marin County resident

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE P

VOTE NO ON THE CHILD CARE PARCEL TAX

This measure locks Marin taxpayers into a new 15-year tax with no defined spending rules, no defined eligibility, and no way to judge results.

The tax ordinance proposes three uses for the $12.5 million raised annually - scholarships, worker wage increases, facility development - but sets no required split. Scholarships only "may" be funded; facilities only "as needed." Wage increases alone get a named target: parity with public transitional kindergarten-through-twelfth grade teacher salaries, a goal that could absorb most of the fund.

Eligibility is vague. No income threshold defines "low- and middle-income." Marin residency isn't required for families, children or workers to benefit. Nothing stops tax dollars from subsidizing a childcare slot or wage increase for someone who lives outside Marin.

Measure P might assist some low- and middle-income families on the benefit side, but offers no similar assistance to taxpayers. There are no exemptions for lower-income homeowners or seniors.

Most well-designed tax measures run 8 -10 years; this lets voters judge results when asked to renew. This one runs 15, with no written performance standards in the ordinance - no target number of scholarships, no wage benchmark or date attached to the TK-12 parity goal, no outcome metrics whatsoever - so no way to know if it will work.

Worse, once passed, spending rules will be written by a commission of unelected appointees, so voters can't hold decision makers accountable. And this measure uses the citizen-initiative process requiring only a simple-majority vote, bypassing the two-thirds vote California requires for special taxes.

Fifteen years funding a program that voters can't measure, run by an unelected commission, is too much to ask - especially when there's no guarantee that a single dollar reduces what any Marin family pays for childcare.

VOTE NO.

SUSAN MORELOCK
Marin County resident

JOHN TURNACLIFF
Marin County resident

AMANDA BEYER
Marin County resident

FRANCIS DROULLIARD
Marin County resident

TIEF GIBBS
Marin County resident and business owner

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE P

The argument against Measure P was signed by some of Marin's most MAGA extremists. Like their MAGA counterparts across the country, they rely on half-truths (at best) in their attempt to undermine this common-sense local solution for Marin families.

Here are the facts:

Measure P includes strong fiscal safeguards. Every dollar must stay in Marin County and be used for early childhood education and childcare. Administrative costs are strictly limited. All expenditures must be approved by the Marin County Board of Supervisors and annual independent audits, public reporting, regular evaluations, and community oversight will ensure taxpayers can see where the money goes and whether it is working.

And the need is urgent.

Marin families face crushing childcare costs, and too few spaces are available. Parents are forced to cut work hours or leave jobs because they cannot find reliable, affordable care. Childcare educators, the people we trust during the most important years of brain development, are leaving the profession because they cannot afford to live and work here. Local employers struggle to recruit and retain workers when employees cannot find quality, affordable preschool.

Measure P tackles all three problems: making care more affordable for families, expanding the number of childcare spaces, and strengthening the early educator workforce.

That is a smart investment in children, working families, local businesses, and Marin's future.

This is not a partisan issue. Don't let misleading claims stand in the way of a solution our children, families and entire community urgently needs.

Vote YES on Measure P.

OurKidsMarin.org

JARED HUFFMAN
U.S. Congressman

JOANNE WEBSTER
Business Leader

HEIDI TOMSKY
Executive Director, Fairfax- San Anselmo Children's Center

CURTIS ROBINSON, MD
Marin County School Board President

PAT JOHNSTONE
Chair, Marin County Democratic Party DCCM

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE P

RESOLUTION NO. 2026-072

A RESOLUTION OF THE MARIN COUNTY BOARD OF SUPERVISORS (1) ACCEPTING THE CERTIFICATE OF SUFFICIENCY FOR THE VOTER-SPONSORED "MARIN COUNTY CHILD CARE INITIATIVE"; (2) CALLING AND GIVING NOTICE OF A SPECIAL ELECTION WITHIN THE COUNTY OF MARIN FOR THE PURPOSE OF SUBMITTING THE INITIATIVE MEASURE TO THE VOTERS; AND (3) REQUESTING CONSOLIDATION OF THE SPECIAL ELECTION WITH THE NOVEMBER 3, 2026 STATEWIDE GENERAL ELECTION

WHEREAS, Pursuant to the California Elections Code, an initiative petition entitled the "Marin County Child Care Initiative" ("Initiative") was filed with the Marin County Registrar of Voters, for the purpose of submitting a proposed special parcel tax measure to the voters of Marin County; and

WHEREAS, on January 28, 2026, the proponents filed a Notice of Intention to Circulate Petition, and on January 29, 2026, filed the text of the proposed initiative ordinance, with the Marin County Registrar of Voters and thereafter complied with the publication requirements of the California Elections Code; and

WHEREAS, the proponents circulated the petition for signatures and, on June 3, 2026, submitted the petition to the Marin County Registrar of Voters for signature verification; and

WHEREAS, on June 17, 2026, the Marin County Registrar of Voters certified that the petition contained the requisite number of valid signatures of registered voters required under the California Elections Code to qualify the Initiative for placement on the ballot ("Certificate of Signature Verification"); and

WHEREAS, pursuant to the California Elections Code, the Board of Supervisors is authorized and directed to submit the proposed Initiative to the voters; and

WHEREAS, the Board of Supervisors has determined that the Initiative shall be submitted to the voters;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Marin County Board of Supervisors as follows:

1. Acceptance of Certificate of Signature Verification. The Board hereby accepts the Certificate of Signature Verification issued by the Marin County Registrar of Voters certifying that the Marin County Child Care Initiative contains the requisite number of valid signatures and qualifies for submission to the voters.
2. Call and Order of Special Election. A special election is hereby called and ordered to be held throughout the County of Marin on Tuesday, November 3, 2026, for the purpose of submitting to the voters the Marin County Child Care Initiative in the form set forth in Section 3 below.
3. Form of Ballot Question. The Initiative shall appear and be printed on the ballot in substantially the following form:

   Shall the Marin County Child Care Initiative be adopted to levy a special parcel tax of 5 cents per building square foot, generating approximately $12.5 million annually for fifteen years, to fund affordable childcare and high-quality early childhood education and improve compensation to retain and attract educators, with public disclosure, optional annual inflation adjustments, and a corresponding increase in the County appropriations limit, with all funds used locally in Marin County?

   YES

   NO
4. Full Text of Initiative; Not to be Printed in Ballot Pamphlet. The full text of the Marin County Child Care Initiative is attached hereto as Exhibit A. Notwithstanding its attachment to this Resolution, the full text of the Initiative shall not be printed in the ballot pamphlet.
5. Copy of Initiative Available to Voters. A copy of the Initiative shall be made available to any voter upon request to the Marin County Registrar of Voters at no cost and shall be posted on the County's website in accordance with California Elections Code sections 9312 and 9313.
6. Consolidation and Conduct of Election. Pursuant to Part 3 (commencing with Section 10400) of the California Elections Code, the Marin County Board of Supervisors hereby orders that the special election be consolidated with the November 3, 2026 Statewide General Election. Upon consolidation, the election shall be held and conducted in all respects as though there were only one election, and only one form of ballot shall be used, the election precincts, polling places, election officers, canvass, certification of results, and all other proceedings shall be conducted by the Marin County Registrar of Voters in accordance with applicable provisions of the California Elections Code governing consolidated elections.
7. Notice of Election. The Marin County Registrar of Voters is requested to give notice of the election in accordance with law and to perform all other acts where are required for holding and conduct of said election.
8. Deadline for Ballot Arguments. Primary ballot arguments and rebuttal arguments concerning the Initiative may be submitted in accordance with Elections Code sections 9315 through 9317 and the deadlines established by the Marin County Registrar of Voters for the November 3, 2026 Statewide General Election.
9. Impartial Analysis. Pursuant to Elections Code section 9313, the Marin County Registrar of Voters shall transmit a copy of the Initiative to the Marin County Counsel, who is hereby directed to prepare an impartial analysis of the Initiative in accordance with the Elections Code and the deadlines established by

the Registrar of Voters.

10. Conduct of Election. Except as otherwise provided herein, the election shall be held and conducted in accordance with the California Elections Code governing the Statewide General Election on November 3, 2026.
11. Further Actions Necessary. The Clerk of the Board, County Executive, County Counsel, Marin County Registrar of Voters, and all other appropriate County officers and employees are hereby authorized and directed to take all actions and execute all documents necessary or desirable to carry out the purposes of this Resolution and to comply with applicable provisions of law.
12. Filing with the Registrar of Voters. The Clerk of the Board is directed to transmit a certified copy of this Resolution to the Marin County Registrar of Voters immediately following its adoption.
13. Resolution of Election Results. Following the canvass of returns and certification of the election results by the Marin County Registrar of Voters, the Board of Supervisors shall declare the results of the election in accordance with the California Elections Code.
14. CEQA Findings. The Board finds that adoption of this Resolution does not constitute a project within the meaning of the California Environmental Quality Act pursuant to CEQA Guidelines sections 15060(c)(2), 15060(c)(3), and 15378(b)(4), and therefore no environmental review is required.
15. Effective Date. This Resolution shall take effect immediately upon its adoption.

Vote Certification
Marin County Board of Supervisors

This hereby certifies the vote taken by the Board of Supervisors on Request to adopt a resolution calling a special election on the voter-sponsored "Marin County Child Care Initiative," consolidating the special election with the November 3, 2026 Statewide General Election at its meeting of Tuesday, July 14, 2026.

AYES: Stephanie Moulton-Peters, Dennis Rodoni, Mary Sackett, Eric Lucan, Brian Colbert

NOES:

ABSENT:

ABSTAIN:

The motion was Approved.

ATTEST:

Derek Johnson
County Executive